Activity 03 - Create a Timeline Infographic with Microsoft 365 Copilot

- Course: Generative AI for Powerpoint (C012)
- Topic 2: Creating PowerPoint Infographics with AI
- Duration: 40 minutes
- Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot app + PowerPoint
- Output: Editable template-based portrait infographic plus PDF and JPG exports

Objective

Create a timeline infographic in the microsoft 365 copilot app, then preserve hierarchy, editability, brand and evidence in powerpoint.

Scenario

Northstar HR needs a five-milestone onboarding timeline for managers: account request, manager plan, Day 1 orientation, Day 7 skills check and Day 30 outcome review. Use Microsoft 365 Copilot Create > Design an infographic with the supplied structured prompt and approved brief. Refine the selected Wide timeline in PowerPoint; do not let generated decoration replace dated evidence.

Detailed instructions

1. Open Microsoft 365 Copilot. Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app and sign in only with an approved account. Choose Create > Design an infographic. If the feature is unavailable, use the supplied editable start deck and record the fallback.

2. Write the timeline prompt. Copy the structured prompt from PROMPTS.md. Specify five onboarding milestones, the manager audience, the pre-boarding decision, professional style, Wide format and the approved source rule.

3. Add approved content. Select +Add content where available and choose only the supplied onboarding brief or workbook. Do not upload personal employee records or restricted files.

4. Choose brand and format. Select Brand and color where available, then choose Wide format for a presentation slide. Keep the approved blue, teal, violet and amber system.

5. Generate and select. Select Create, inspect the alternatives and choose the direction with the clearest chronological order. Reject any option with invented dates, labels or outcomes.

6. Apply the approved style. Use Design > Variants > Colors and Fonts or apply the supplied palette manually. Keep one heading font, one body font and consistent stage colours.

7. Check alignment. Select comparable stage objects, then choose Shape Format > Align > Align Middle and Distribute Vertically. Group each stage after alignment.

8. Add accessibility data. Right-click meaningful images and choose View Alt Text. Write purpose-focused alt text; mark decorative objects as decorative where supported.

9. Export and inspect. Use File > Export > Create PDF/XPS for PDF and File > Save As > PNG for an image. Compare the outputs with the editable master for clipping and font changes.

Suggested timing

- 5 minutes - Template selection and working copy

- 10 minutes - Placeholder audit and content replacement
- 15 minutes - Brand, hierarchy and alignment
- 7 minutes - Accessibility and export
- 3 minutes - Save and submit

Included inputs and assets

- Synthetic CSV and formula-enabled XLSX mock data
- Editable PowerPoint start and worked-example files
- PROMPTS.md with an activity-specific structured Microsoft 365 Copilot prompt plus analysis, refinement and review prompts
- AI Prompt Lab worksheet for provenance and human-change records

Submission

Submit the editable PPTX, completed XLSX, source CSV, prompt/source log, used assets and checklist. Record every AI tool, prompt, source, rejected claim and material human change.

Debrief

The final template-based infographic is message-led, branded, accessible, source-labelled and fully editable.